

# ZHENFENG ZHOU

163 Xianlin Avenue, Nanjing, Jiangsu, 210023

Website: <https://zhou-zhen-feng.github.io/>

Email: [zhouzhenfeng02@gmail.com](mailto:zhouzhenfeng02@gmail.com)

Update: March 2026

## EDUCATION

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### Nanjing University

M.A. in Computational Communication; Advisor: Dr. Cheng-Jun Wang; GPA: 4.60 / 5

Nanjing, China

2023–present

### Lanzhou University

B.A. in Journalism and Communications (graduated with honors); GPA: 3.98 / 5

Lanzhou, China

2019–2023

## PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

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- [1] **Zhou, Z.**, & Ma, Z.\* (2025). Evaluating the Brief Resilience Scale in 21 Countries: Psychometric Properties and Measurement Invariance Across Sex, Age, and Countries.  
– **Assessment**. Accepted in August 2025.
- [2] **Zhou, Z.**, & Ma, Z.\* (2025). Understanding the Co-occurrence of Depressive and Anxiety Symptoms Among 2021 Henan Flood Victims Through Panel Network Analysis: A 6-Month, Three- Wave Longitudinal Study.  
– **Journal of Clinical Psychology**. Accepted in October 2025.

## SELECTED WORKS IN PROGRESS

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- [3] **Zhou, Z.**, Liu, Y., Xiao, X.,& Wang, C.J.\* (2025). The Unintended Consequences of Emancipation: The Abolition of Slavery and the Rise of Racist Narratives in Southern U.S.Newspapers (1800-1920).  
<https://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.5244337>
- [4] Liu, Y., **Zhou, Z.**,& Wang, C.J.\* (2025). Unpacking the Black Box of Hostility: Threat Perception, Moral Judgement, and Aggressive Rhetoric in China’s Diplomatic Press Conferences.

## CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

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- [3] **Zhou, Z.**, Liu, Y., Xiao, X.,&Wang, C.J.\* (2025). The Unintended Consequences of Emancipation: The Abolition of Slavery and the Rise of Racist Narratives in Southern U.S. Newspapers (1800-1920).  
– Paper was presented at *the 111th Annual National Communication Association Conference (NCA)*, Denver, USA, 2025.  
– Latest paper will be presented at *the 76th Annual Conference of the International Communication Association (ICA)*, Cape Town, South Africa,2026.
- [4] Liu, Y., **Zhou, Z.**,& Wang, C.J.\* (2025). Unpacking the Black Box of Hostility: Threat Perception, Moral Judgement, and Aggressive Rhetoric in China’s Diplomatic Press Conferences.  
– Paper was presented at *the 75rd Annual International Communication Association Conference (ICA)*, Denver, USA,2025.
- [5] Sun, Y., **Zhou, Z.**, & Wang, C.J.\* (2024) Building Identity Through Narratives: Who Voices Dissent Within the Party?.  
– Paper was presented at *the 107th Annual Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication Conference (AEJMC)*,Philadelphia,USA,2024.

## UNDER REVIEW

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- [4] Liu, Y., **Zhou, Z.**, & Wang, C.J.\* (2025). Unpacking the Black Box of Hostility: Threat Perception, Moral Judgement, and Aggressive Rhetoric in China's Diplomatic Press Conferences.  
– Under review at Chinese Journal of Communication (CJOC)

## HONORS and AWARDS

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- National Encouragement Scholarship for Undergraduate Student Oct 2020
- National Encouragement Scholarship for Undergraduate Student Oct 2021
- Internet+ College Students Innovation and Entrepreneurship Competition (Bronze Medalist) May 2022
- International Genetically Engineered Machine Competition (Gold Medalist) Oct 2022
- Graduate Academic First-Class Award (¥12,000) Nov 2024
- the 10th China National Conference on Big Data Social Computing (Second-Class Award ¥5000) Aug 2025
- Sun Xiangzhen Award (¥8000) Aug 2025

## PROJECT

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### External

- National Social Science Foundation of China (22BXW032), ¥200,000, *Research Fellow* 2022–2025  
– **Project title:** *Computational Narrative Research on Chinese Stories and Chinese Voices in the Digital Media Era* (PI: Cheng-Jun Wang)

### Internal

- Classification and Prediction of China-Related Sentiment in X Texts, *Collaborator* 2025–Feb 2026.  
– **Primary Responsibilities:** *Using LLMs to extract textual features with human validation to train BERT-based models for predicting sentiment toward China on X.*
- Distinguished Postgraduate Talent Cultivation Program (2024GYB13), ¥6000, *Collaborator* 2024–2026  
– **Primary Responsibilities:** *Identified semantically related terms associated with aggressive rhetoric in Chinese MFA spokesperson corpora using PMI and embedding-based NLP approaches.*

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCES

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Computational Communication Collaboratory, Nanjing University (member) Nanjing, China  
Sep 2023–present

## SKILLS

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- **Statistical Programming:** Python, R, Stata
- **Languages:** Mandarin (Native), English
- **Applications:** Qualtrics, Amazon Mechanical Turk, Photoshop, Premier Pro, Audition
- **sports:** Badminton and Cycling